

vision2learn

Part of  Knowledgepool

Business and Administration

Hints and Tips

Unit 1



Contents

Section 1 - Know the employment rights and responsibilities of the employee and employer	4
Section 2 - All about health, safety and security	6
Section 3 – Communicating effectively with others	7
Section 4 – Working with others	8
Section 5 – Planning your own work	9
Section 6 – Improving your performance	10
Section 7 – Problems at work	11

Hints and Tips Unit 1

The information in this guide will be helpful to you when you are ready to complete your assessment for the following unit:

Unit one: Principles of personal responsibilities and working in a business environment

Section 1 - Know the employment rights and responsibilities of the employee and employer

Q1. Identify four main points that would be included in a contract of employment. If possible, use an example contract to support your answer (feel free to obscure any confidential information).

Here, you must list four main points that would be included in a contract of employment.

Q2a. & Q2b. List three key points of legislation that affect employers in a business environment. AND List three key points of legislation that affect employees in a business environment.

This question is in two parts and you must include three key areas of legislation that affect the employer and three key areas of legislation that affect the employee. The legislation can be the same for both the employer and employee.

Q3. Identify a range of places where a person can find information on employment rights and responsibilities. You should identify at least two internal and two external sources of information.

Here, you must list two internal and two external sources of information on employment rights and responsibilities.

Q4. Describe how representative bodies can support employees.

In this question, you need to describe how representative bodies can support employees. A good source of information regarding trade unions can be found at www.tuc.org.uk

Q5. Identify employer and employee responsibilities for equality and diversity in a business environment. You should give at least two employer responsibilities and two employee responsibilities.

This question is in two parts - employer and employee responsibilities - and you must answer both parts to pass the question successfully. In addition to the learning materials, 'EHRC: Advice and Guidance' has some excellent information that can help you answer this question.

Q6. Explain the benefits of making sure equality and diversity procedures are followed in a business environment. Your answer should include one benefit for the employer, one benefit for the employee and one benefit for the overall organisation.

This is a three-part question in which you need to include a benefit for the employer, the employee and the organisation as a whole.

Section 2 - All about health, safety and security

Q1a. & Q1b. Identify employer and employee responsibilities for health and safety. AND Identify employer and employee responsibilities for security.

This question is in two parts. You need to include both employer and employee responsibilities for health, safety and security. In addition to the course materials, www.hse.gov.uk provides useful information on employer and employee responsibilities for health and safety.

Q2. Explain the purpose of following health, safety and security procedures in a business environment.

Why does managing health and safety properly make good business sense? In addition to the learning materials, a good article about this can be found at <http://www.healthandsafetyworksni.gov.uk/whymanagehealthandsafety>.

Q3. Describe three different ways of maintaining a safe and secure business environment.

You must provide three descriptions in your answer. Think about how you can contribute to the safety and security of your work or business environment. Can you think of any real-life examples to support your answer?

Section 3 – Communicating effectively with others

Q1. Describe three different methods of communication. You should include two verbal, two non-verbal and two written methods of communication.

Include two examples for verbal, non-verbal and written communication. You should include a description of the communication methods you are using in your answer. It is not sufficient just to list the communication methods as your answer

Q2. Using two specific examples, explain how to choose the most appropriate method of communication to meet your needs and the needs of others.

If you needed to speak with your Manager regarding a confidential issue, how would you approach them i.e. face-to-face, telephone, email? Would you approach them in private or in a public place where people can hear you?

Q3. Describe at least two ways of actively listening.

As well as using the course materials, a good article about active listening can be found at <http://www.mindtools.com/CommSkill/ActiveListening.htm>

Section 4 – Working with others

Q1. Explain the purpose of agreeing standards for your own work. Give at least two reasons.

You need to explain why 'having standards of work' is important, rather than listing different standards, such as 'must answer 10 telephone calls in an hour'. If you didn't have standards of work, how would you know if you are doing a good job or not? How will colleagues who depend on you know what to expect if you don't have standards?

Q2. Explain the purpose of taking on new challenges and being able to adapt to change at work.

If you're willing to take on new challenges, will this make you more valuable to the organisation or not? Will you learn new skills? If you resist new challenges and changes, how will your colleagues feel about you?

Q3. Explain the purpose of treating others with honesty and consideration.

If you are honest and respectful to your colleagues, how do you think this will affect the work environment? Will it help to build better working relationships or not? Also, how would you expect colleagues to behave towards you if you are unfriendly and unhelpful to them?

Section 5 – Planning your own work

Q1. Explain the purpose of meeting work standards and deadlines when completing tasks in a business environment.

Why is it important you meet the work standards required of you? What would the consequences of not meeting your work standards be?

Q2. Identify two different methods that you can use to plan your own work in a business environment.

What tools and techniques can you use to plan your work? You need to describe two methods you can use to plan your work. A good source of time management tools and techniques can be found at http://www.mindtools.com/pages/main/newMN_HTE.htm.

Q3. Describe ways of keeping other people informed about progress and compare their effectiveness. What are the benefits and drawbacks of each approach?

You need to select two communication methods you could use to keep people informed of your work progress, i.e. face-to-face, telephone, email, meetings and give a benefit and drawback for each of them.

Section 6 – Improving your performance

Q1. Explain the purpose of continuously improving your performance in a business environment.

Here, you must explain the purpose of continuously improving your performance in a business environment. What benefits does it bring to the business and the employee? It is not enough to just list your answers; you must give your answers and then expand upon them with further reasoning as to the benefits of continuously improving your performance.

Q2. Describe at least two ways of improving your performance at work. Where relevant, illustrate your answer with specific examples from your own experience.

You need to give specific examples of how you can improve your performance at work. Could you do extra training, work shadowing, have a coach/mentor at work or use a learning plan? You need to describe how these steps could improve your performance at work.

Q3. Identify at least two different types of career pathways or options that may be available to you.

What types of career could you do? Be specific with your answer.

Section 7 – Problems at work

Q1. Identify at least two different types of problems that can occur in a business environment.

You must identify at least two types of problems that can occur in a business environment. You should include at least one minor problem and one major problem.

Q2. Describe at least two specific problems that can occur at work and explain how they can be dealt with.

In Q1 you were asked to identify types of problem whereas this question asks you to describe specific problems. You looked at several examples on Page 2 of the course materials. Try and think of your own examples then explain how you, or the organisation, could deal with each one. Think about who might be able to help and what knowledge or experience would be useful when dealing with these issues. Each explanation should be at least 50 words long.

Q3. List at least two problems you are able to deal with yourself and two problems you would need to refer to others to deal with. Explain how and when you would refer these problems to others.

You may use any type of problem for this question, think about who is best placed to fix this problem and why. Then explain, how you could transfer any problems to other relevant people. How and when would you do this? Would it be done verbally or would you have to complete a form or send a recorded email?